

Awards

A Brief History of the Ore Gangue Alumni Bursary Fund

By Gord Beach

We, the Alumni, have always been a close bunch here in Calgary. After migrating to the city upon graduating and taking up careers, usually in the oil and gas industry, we continued the comradery that had developed in Saskatoon as members of the Ore Gangue during our student days. The Ore Gangue had become a very important part of our lives as students and it was seldom we were not in the company of our classmates and friends. We were very tight there in Saskatoon and continued to be so here in Calgary.

One of the more popular events that developed and drew us together was a golf tournament. It was held in the fall and played at several venues in the Calgary area. It became a very popular day and was attended by a lot of Alumni. It still is. I know it became the prime golf fixture on my calendar every year. I look forward to it every year I am able to take part. After several years participation I eventually felt it was only right that I should join the organizing committee and help pay back the initial organizers. For several years I enjoyed the company of, and the pleasure of working with, the Committee members. The Committee did a great job of making sure we all had a very enjoyable time, complete with meals before and after the game and a prize table that often groaned under the weight of prizes donated by players and sponsors. To this day this continues to be the case. Some of the members have been on the committee since the original tournament held in 2000. I do not believe I played in the inaugural tournament, but I can be sure of the date thanks to a recent photo in the Ore Gangue Alumni Newsletter, sent out by Tracey Jungwirth, showing a foursome from that tournament. The Golf Tournament Committee should be commended for their hard work.

Over the years I had also participated in the CSPG Men's Golf Tournament. It too was well attended and sponsored. I remember well being struck one year by a very significant change in the very makeup of that tournament. A couple of gentlemen had convinced the organizers to begin a program of partnering with a local charitable organization to raise funds for the benefit of that charity. I thought it was a commendable idea. In fact I appropriated their idea and began to speak with the Ore Gangue Golf Committee about the idea of using the annual get together to help fund some form of Alumni Fund that would be of benefit to students in the Department in Saskatoon. It should be noted that the Golf Committee had already begun to support the Department by each year donating funds to the Michael D. Welch Book Prize for the Library. Over the years they have generously raised well over \$20,000.00 to donate to this fund. After a year or two of general discussion, in 2010 I asked the Golf Committee to allow me to fire myself with the intention that if I could get some form of fund organized they would consider a partnership to support the fund. They have been unwavering in their support ever since. They have contributed almost \$45,000.00 from funds raised at their tournament.

I had become a committed attendee at the down town YMCA as part of my attempt to keep fit and active. I was not the only one who felt strongly about the "therapy" available at the Y. One of the other people was Paul Gagnon. Over the years Paul and I became friends. I began to speak to him regarding my idea of starting an Alumni fund. I suggested to him that I thought we might set up a fund with a target large enough to support a student at the Department in a significant way, say \$50,000.00 or \$100,000.00.

Awards

A Brief History of the Ore Gangue Alumni Bursary Fund

By Gord Beach

Paul, in his very insightful way, convinced me that if we were going to make the effort to start a fund we should start a "fund", not a coin collection. He suggested that he had a colleague or two that he would speak to about joining the Committee (he actually gathered up four or five), AND, brilliantly, that perhaps the way to go about setting up the committee was to solicit representative from each decade of graduates for as far back as we could manage. And so began the first seeds of the Alumni Fund Committee. We set about our search for members and, true to Ore Gangue fashion, the Alumni stepped up and the Ore Gangue Alumni Fund Committee was established. After our committee membership was set we gathered and laid out the premises of the Fund. Our fund raising goal would be \$500,000.00, supporting up to four 3rd and 4th year students per year who showed academic prowess but also were Ore Gangue members contributing to earth sciences community in the Department but, as or more importantly, were in need of financial aid. The basic tenets of our Fund, having been set, we searched out the appropriate people in the U of S Administration and proceeded to document the Terms of Reference, under which the proceeds of the Fund would be administered and the bursaries paid out to award recipients. To be honest, this proved to be a frustrating experience which took well over a year to finalize. It actually didn't come to a conclusion until I flew to Saskatoon and met with administration, who by the way, were not those that began the process. In under an hour we had the terms finalized.

That accomplished, the fund was formally established and the initial letter of contact was sent out July 09, 2011. Our fundraising had begun. The first awards were made in 2013. Awards have been between \$2,500.00 and \$3,500.00, with seven students benefiting to this point. At this time the Fund total is approaching \$200,000.00.

Individual Alumni have made great contributions as well to this venture. I would be remiss in not mentioning Dave Nordin, whose "Walking Back to Saskatoon" project raised funds for the Heart and Stroke Foundation and \$12,700.00 for the Alumni Fund. Dave walked 600 KM from Calgary to the Geological Sciences Department in Saskatoon through all manner of weather conditions, a project that took him more than a month. Well done Dave.

I am very grateful to Paul for his support. Without it I am certain I would never have been able to get the Fund off the ground. As well, I thank Lorne Larson, Tony Cadrin, Tyler Klatt, and Lori Barth, as local active members, and Jim Corman, Dale Pyke, Don Sykes, Murray Roed and Jim Merriam as members and representatives "away".

This has been a challenging but rewarding project. The real drivers in its success have been Paul Gagnon and the other Fund Committee members, Ron McKellar and the Golf Committee members, people like Dave Nordin and, of course, the Alumni. An example of Alumni support is that of our recently deceased friend George McLeod, whose obituary asked for donations to the Fund.

Thank you very much, all of you. I am proud to be associated with such a fine group of people.

Gordon Beach

March, 2018

Awards

A Brief History of the Ore Gangue Alumni Bursary Fund

By Gord Beach

For anyone wanting to contribute to the fund, please go to:

<http://www.oregangue.org/alumni-fund.php>

Ore Gangue Alumni award winners:

- 2017: Bryce Marinus & Naethen Parthiban
- 2016: Cowell Mattea
- 2014/2015: Joshua Wallace & Corrie Davidson

Articles on Dave Walking Back to Saskatoon as a Scholarship Fund raiser event are:

<https://words.usask.ca/alumninews/2016/06/07/dave-nordins-steps-to-saskatoon/>

<http://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/saskatoon/university-saskatchewan-alum-walking-to-saskatoon-1.3639082>

<http://www.drumhellermail.com/news/28482-calgary-man-walks-to-saskatoon-for-heart-and-stroke-foundation>

Awards

A Brief History of the Ore Gangue Alumni Bursary Fund

By Gord Beach

Walking Back to Saskatoon

Photo with students L to R:

Matthew Nadeau
Aiden Mowat
Brayden McDonald
(Dave Nordin)
Colton Vessey
Ty Mcgee
Mattea Cowell
Ben Swerhone
Nate Reimer

With Faculty L to R:

Jim Basinger
Camille Partin
Kevin Ansdell
(D.N.)
Malcolm Reeves
Jim Merriam
Matt Lindsay

Photo with contemporaries L to R:

Gary Linassi
Brian Janser
Darcy Hirsekorn
(D.N.)
Dave Billard
Jim Merriam

